



AmeriCloud Telecom Solutions, LLC

Company Handbook

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Introduction

Welcome to AmeriCloud Telecom Solutions, LLC; (the Company), where connection is more than a signal, it's a purpose!

We're excited to have you join our journey as we shape the future of telecommunications. Whether you're working behind the scenes on infrastructure, engaging directly with customers, or driving innovation through technology, your role is vital to our mission: to connect people, empower communities, and enable progress through reliable and transformative communication services.

At AmeriCloud Telecom, we believe in:

- **Integrity:** We do what's right, even when no one's watching.
- **Innovation:** We challenge the status quo to build what's next.
- **Customer Centricity:** We listen, we care, and we deliver.
- **Collaboration:** We grow stronger together.
- **Excellence:** We aim high and hold ourselves accountable.

This handbook is intended to serve as a guide for employees of the Company and supersedes all prior versions. This handbook is not intended to cover all issues regarding your employment. The Company reserves the right to amend, withdraw or revise the policies outlined herein at any time with or without prior notice. This handbook will guide you in understanding our culture, policies, and expectations. It's designed to help you navigate your journey here with confidence and clarity. We encourage you to read it thoroughly, refer to it often, and reach out if you ever need support or clarification. For any interpretation of the policy, please reach out to Human Resources department at hr@americloudtelecom.com

We are pleased to welcome you to our T.E.A.M. (Together Everyone Achieves More) and hope that your experience with the Company will be one of mutual respect, satisfaction, and personally rewarding.

Warm regards,

Saleem Waheed

Chief Executive Officer

Note: No employee handbook can anticipate every circumstance concerning Human Resource related policies or occurrences. Therefore, The Company reserves the right to revise, supplement, or rescind any policies or portions of the handbook from time to time as

it deems appropriate, at its sole and absolute discretion. The Company will notify employees of any handbook changes as they occur in a timely manner.

Welcome to AmeriCloud Telecom Solutions, LLC.

You are now part of a team that keeps people connected — from infrastructure in the field to systems behind the scenes. In telecommunications, reliability is everything. Our customers depend on us to deliver performance, uptime, and precision — and that starts with the people who make it happen every day.

Whether you are working on-site, in the office, remotely, or traveling to project locations, your role directly impacts our network strength, service quality, and company reputation. At AmeriCloud Telecom, we stand for:

- *Safety First* – No project is more important than the well-being of our team.
- *Accountability* – We take ownership of our work and our results.
- *Professionalism* – We represent the Company with integrity at every job site and customer location.
- *Teamwork* – Field crews, engineers, project managers, and support staff work as one unit.
- *Precision & Performance* – In telecom, details matter. Quality work protects our customers and our future.

This Handbook outlines the standards, expectations, and policies that guide how we operate — from safety protocols and travel procedures to conduct, compliance, and benefits. These policies are designed to protect you, your teammates, our customers, and the Company.

Telecom work demands flexibility, discipline, and commitment. Some days will require travel, long hours, and rapid response to changing project conditions. We rely on each other to stay focused, follow procedures, communicate clearly, and get the job done right the first time.

If you ever have questions, concerns, or need guidance, your supervisor and Human Resources are here to support you.

We are proud to have you on the AmeriCloud Telecom team. Together, we build, maintain, and strengthen the connections that power businesses and communities.

Stay safe. Stay professional. Stay connected.

Welcome to the team.

Vision, Mission, Values

Vision, Mission, and Values are defined according to the strategic direction and culture of the organization:

Vision: outlines what the organization aspires to achieve in the future.

Mission Statement: defines the organization's purpose and primary objectives.

Values: core principles and ethical standards that guide the behavior and decision-making processes within the organization.

(to be provided by Mateen)

What you can expect from the Company

The Company provides a safe, healthy, and aesthetically inviting working environment where your talent can be utilized to impact on the Company's business plan and maximize your professional potential. As a valued member of our team, you can expect the company to provide:

A diversified and Respectful Workplace

We are committed to maintaining a work environment that is inclusive, respectful, and free from discrimination or harassment.

Equal Opportunities Employer

We are an equal opportunities employer and committed to fair treatment of all employees and job applicants, regardless of race, gender, age, religion, disability or sexual orientation.

Clear Communication

You will receive timely updates about company policies, goals, and changes. We believe transparency builds trust.

Opportunities for Growth

Whether through training, mentorship, or promotions, we encourage continuous learning and career development.

Supportive Leadership

Our management team is here to guide, support, and listen. We value your input and strive to foster a culture of collaboration. We believe in an open-door policy where employees are encouraged to freely discuss concerns, ideas or issues without fear of retribution or discomfort.

Recognition and Appreciation

Your contributions matter. We celebrate achievements and recognize the hard work that drives our success.

Work-Life Balance

We respect your time and encourage a healthy balance between work and personal life.

Employee Concerns

If any employee has concerns or issues related to a supervisor, compliance with policies or procedures or any other personal matter please contact the Human Resources department at hr@americloudtelecom.com or contact 847-380-4180 Ext 100 if you have any questions regarding your rights.

Office Locations

Following are the Company's office locations:

Illinois – HQ

AmeriCloud Telecom Solutions, LLC.
1635 W. Wise Rd., Suite #8
Schaumburg, IL 60193

Texas

AmeriCloud Telecom Solutions, LLC.
6136 Frisco Square Blvd, Suite #400
Frisco, TX 75034

India

AmeriCloud Telecom Solutions, LLC.
Sai Shritha Meadows, Plot No. 345, Road No. 7,
Kakatiya Hills, Madhapur, Hyderabad, Telangana 500081

SECTION 1 - Employment

1.1. **Nature of employment**

The Company is an “at will” employer where your employment status is on a voluntary basis. The “at will” model allows the Company to maintain an employment relationship with you that meets the conditions outlined within this handbook and also gives you options for extending or ending your tenure of employment at any time, with or without cause. Similarly, the Company may terminate the employment relationship “at will”, at any time, with or without notice or cause, so long as there is no violation of applicable federal, state or local laws.

This Handbook does not limit management's discretion to make personnel decisions such as reassignment, change of wages and benefits, demotion, etc. No person other than the President, CEO, or CFO has the authority to enter into an agreement for employment for any specified period of time or to make an agreement for employment other than “at will”, which is only binding if it is in writing and signed by the President (CEO or CFO) of the Company.

Policies set forth in this handbook are not intended to create a contractual agreement unless explicitly detailed by the HR Department, nor are they to be construed to constitute a contractual obligation of any kind or a contract of employment between the Company and any of its employees. The provisions of the handbook have been developed at the discretion of corporate management and may be amended or cancelled at any time, at the Company's sole discretion.

These provisions supersede all existing policies and practices and may not be amended or added to without the express written approval of the Company's Management Team in conjunction with the HR department.

1.2. **Equal Employment Opportunity & Americans with Disability Act**

To provide equal employment and advancement opportunities to all individuals, employment decisions will be based on merit, qualifications, current employment landscape, and an assessment of the abilities of the employee being considered. The Company does not discriminate in employment opportunities or practices based on race, color, religion, sex, gender, national origin, age, disability, or any other characteristics protected by law. It is the policy of the Company to hire the best qualified job applicant and to treat all employees fairly and equally without regard for race, color, sex, sexual orientation, age, national origin, disability, religion, marital status, or any other classifications protected by law.

The Company complies with the Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA), as amended by the ADA Amendments Act, and all applicable state or local law. Consistent with those requirements, the Company will reasonably accommodate qualified individuals with a disability if such accommodation would allow the individual to perform the essential functions of the job, unless doing so would create an undue hardship. If you believe you need accommodation, refer any such request to the Human Resources Department. The Company will also, where appropriate, provide reasonable accommodation for an employee's religious beliefs or practices.

If you desire religious accommodation, you are required to make the request in writing to your manager as early as possible. You are expected to strive to find co-workers who can assist in the accommodation (e.g., trade shifts) and cooperate with the Company in seeking and evaluating alternatives.

If you are subject to any conduct that you believe violates this policy, you must promptly speak to, write or otherwise contact your direct supervisor and the Human Resources department as soon as possible following the offending conduct or contact the numbers given in Section 2 of this document, under Employee Concerns.

1.3. Brand Awareness

The Company has an exemplary reputation within the Telecom industry. Consumer confidence in the Company continues to steadily rise. Continued protection of the Company branding is important to continue or improve the successful model already in place. Fair trade with our customers and ethical conduct of our employees is mandatory and must be displayed on a daily basis.

1.4. Business and Ethical Conduct

Confidentiality Policy

Employees may have access to confidential information concerning other employees, vendors, and clients. It is the responsibility of all employees to maintain the confidentiality of such information and to handle it with care and discretion.

Employees are specifically expected to protect all customer information collected at Company locations. The release of employment or income verification details regarding current or former employees is strictly prohibited unless authorized through proper channels.

This policy is intended to safeguard the Company and its employees from potential liability resulting from the unauthorized disclosure of sensitive or personal information.

Any breach of this policy may result in disciplinary action, up to and including termination of employment.

Confidentiality of Employment Terms

Employees are strictly prohibited from discussing their salary, bonuses, pay increments, or any other confidential aspects of their employment terms with other employees. This policy is intended to maintain workplace harmony, protect individual privacy, and uphold the confidentiality of employment agreements.

Any breach of this policy may result in disciplinary action, up to and including termination of employment.

1.5. Immigration Law and Compliance

The Company is committed to employing only United States citizens, Permanent Residents and aliens who are authorized to work in the United States and does not unlawfully discriminate on the basis of citizenship or national origin.

In compliance with the Immigration Reform and Control Act of 1986, each new employee, as a condition of employment, must complete the Employment Eligibility Verification Form I-9 and present documentation establishing identity and employment eligibility. Former employees who are rehired must also complete the form if they have not completed an I-9 with the Company within the past three years, or if the previous I-9 is no longer retained or valid.

Employees with questions or seeking more information on immigration law issues are encouraged to contact the Human Resources Department for a confidential review of the details. Employees may raise questions or complaints about immigration law compliance without fear of reprisal.

1.6. Political Neutrality

Maintenance of individual freedom and our political institutions necessitate broad-scale participation by citizens concerning the selection, nomination, and election of our public office holders. The Company will not discriminate against any employee because of identification with and support of any lawful political activity. Company employees are entitled to their own personal political position. The Company will not discriminate against employees based on their lawful political activity engaged outside of work. If you are engaging in political activity, however, you should always make it clear that your actions and opinions are your own and not necessarily those of the Company, and that you are not representing the Company.

1.7. Legal Compliance and Workplace Conduct

All employees are required to uphold the Company's commitment to legal and ethical standards by complying with all applicable laws and regulations, including those related to environmental protection, workplace safety, and fair business practices.

Employees are expected to act responsibly and ethically in all matters involving the Company's finances, equipment, products, partnerships, and public image. Integrity and accountability are essential in maintaining the trust of our stakeholders and the reputation of the Company.

The Company enforces a strict zero-tolerance policy regarding the possession of illegal substances or any form of intoxication in the workplace. Violations of this policy may result in disciplinary action, up to and including termination of employment.

1.8. Ban the Box Law

The Job Opportunities for Qualified Applicants Act (PA 98-0774), more commonly referred to as the "Ban the Box" law, prohibits private sector employers with 15 or more employees from asking job applicants about their criminal background prior to extending an offer of an interview or conditional employment.

1.9. Conflict of Interest

During your employment with the Company, you are prohibited from directly or indirectly competing with AmeriCloud Telecom, including, but not limited to, providing, owning an interest in, or assisting any other person or entity that is in competition with the Company or that provides any product, service or offering of a type that is the same or similar to that provided by AmeriCloud Telecom from time to time.

Additionally, during your employment with the Company, you are prohibited from at any time directly or indirectly working for, assisting or owning an interest in any business or venture that constitutes a conflict of interest. The Company will determine in its sole discretion whether any work or interest constitutes a violation of this policy. Before you begin to directly or indirectly work for, assist or own an interest in any other business or venture other than AmeriCloud Telecom, you must notify your supervisor.

1.10. Outside Employment

Employees may hold outside jobs but will still be required to meet the performance standards of their job description with the Company. All employees will be judged by the same performance standards and will be subject to the Company's scheduling demands, regardless of any existing outside work requirements.

If the Company determines that an employee's outside employment interferes with their ability to perform the duties of their job or negatively impacts the performance of other employees, the employee may be required to terminate the outside employment. If the employee wishes to remain employed with the Company all current job requirements and conditions must be met even if the job description has been modified during this decision-making process.

The Company corporate management team reserves the right to specify, on an individual basis, when a conflict of interest has occurred and/or a particular circumstance is prohibited. Employees may not receive any income or material gain from individuals outside the Company for products or services rendered while performing the duties associated with their job description or any job description at the Company or at any time a conflict of interest is deemed evident.

1.11. Non-Disclosure

The protection of confidential business information and trade secrets is vital to the interests and the success of the Company. Such confidential information includes, but is not limited to, the following examples:

- Compensation Data, Computer Processes, Computer Programs
- Activation Codes, Passwords / Log Ins/ Ids
- Customer Lists, Customer Preferences
- Financial Information
- Labor Relations Strategies
- Marketing Strategies
- Pending Projects and Proposals
- Inventory Data
- Vendors, Partners
- Sensitive Employee Disclosure Information
- Handling of Personal Customer Information
- Any Customer Information
- Employment Applications, Hiring / Firing Decisions
- Disclosure to the Media which is not approved by Management
- Political or Otherwise Endorsements

The Company employees may be required to sign a non-disclosure agreement as a condition of employment. *Only the Chief Executive Officer is authorized to make or approve public statements pertaining to the Company or its operations.* Employees who improperly use or disclose trade secrets, confidential business information or any other information accrued at any of the Company location will be subject to disciplinary action, up to and including termination, pending additional legal action.

1.12. Handling Personal Customer Information

The handling of personal customer information is a necessary part of the daily business of the Company. It is collected for the purpose of establishing an account for the customers or completing lawful inquiries and communications. It is each employee's responsibility to treat all such information as *CONFIDENTIAL* and to protect, safely store and transmit it in a protected manner. Collected personal customer information must be used only for providing service to the customer and never disclosed to any third party without customer consent.

1.13. Disability Accommodation

The Company complies with the Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA), as amended by the ADA Amendments Act (ADAAA), and all applicable state and local fair employment practices laws, and is committed to providing equal employment opportunities to qualified individuals with disabilities. Consistent with this commitment, the Company will provide a reasonable accommodation to disabled applicants and employees if the reasonable accommodation would allow the individual to perform the essential functions of the job, unless doing so would create an undue hardship.

If you believe you need accommodation because of your disability, you are responsible for requesting reasonable accommodation from the Human Resources Department in writing and including relevant information, such as:

- A detailed explanation of the specific accommodation requested to support accessibility or needs
- The reason for requesting accommodation
- How accommodation supports the performance of essential job duties.

After receiving your oral or written request, the Company will engage in an interactive dialogue with you to determine the precise limitations of your disability and explore potential reasonable accommodations that could overcome those limitations. The Company encourages you to suggest specific reasonable accommodation that you believe would allow you to do your job. However, the Company is not required to make the specific accommodation requested by you and may provide alternative, effective accommodation, to the extent any reasonable accommodation can be made without imposing undue hardship on the Company.

If your disability or need for accommodation is not obvious, the Company may ask you to provide supporting documents showing that you have a disability within the meaning of the ADA and applicable state or local laws, and that your disability necessitates reasonable accommodation. If the information provided in response to this request is insufficient, the Company may require that you see a healthcare professional of the Company's choosing, at the Company's expense. In those cases, if you fail to provide the requested information or see the designated health care professional, your request for reasonable accommodation may be denied.

The Company will keep confidential any medical information that it obtains in connection with your request for reasonable accommodation.

The Company makes determinations about reasonable accommodation on a case-to-case basis considering various factors and based on an individualized assessment in each situation.

The Company strives to make determinations on reasonable accommodation requests expeditiously and will inform the individual once a determination has been made. If you

have any questions about a reasonable accommodation request you made, please contact the Human Resources Department.

Individuals will not be retaliated against for requesting accommodation in good faith. The Company expressly prohibits any form of discipline, reprisal, intimidation or retaliation against any individual for requesting accommodation in good faith.

The Company is committed to enforcing this policy and prohibiting retaliation against employees and applicants who request accommodation in good faith. However, the effectiveness of our efforts depends largely on individuals telling us about inappropriate workplace conduct. If employees or applicants feel that they or someone else may have been subjected to conduct that violates this policy, they should report it immediately to the Human Resources Department. If employees do not report retaliatory conduct, The Company may not become aware of a possible violation of this policy and may not be able to take appropriate corrective action.

1.14. **Religious Accommodation**

The Company complies with Title VII of the Civil Rights Act of 1964 and is committed to providing equal employment opportunities to all individuals, regardless of their religious beliefs and practices or lack thereof. Consistent with this commitment, the Company will provide reasonable accommodation of employees sincerely held religious belief if the accommodation would resolve a conflict between the individual's religious beliefs or practices and a work requirement, unless doing so creates an undue hardship for the Company.

If you believe you need accommodation because of your religious beliefs or practices or lack thereof, you are responsible for requesting accommodation from the Human Resources Department. You may make the request in writing. The Company encourages employees to make their request in writing and to include relevant information, such as:

- A detailed explanation of the specific accommodation requested
- The reason for requesting accommodation
- How the accommodation will help resolve the conflict between your religious beliefs or practices or lack thereof and one or more of your work requirements.

1.15. **Dress Code**

What we wear to work reflects the pride we have in the Company, in what we do, and in ourselves. Although dress code requirements will vary according to job responsibilities, your appearance always should show discretion, good taste, and appropriateness for the safe performance of your job.

In general, clothing should be clean, neat, well-fitting, and non-offensive. Examples of acceptable attire include collared shirts (button-down or polo style), sweaters, jackets, blouses, skirts, dresses, slacks, khakis, and well-maintained/tailored jeans. Shoes can be either formal or casual, and sandals are acceptable.

These are the factors you should consider:

- Maintaining the highest standards relating to personal hygiene, including regular bathing and use of deodorant, brushing teeth and using mouthwash as necessary, always maintaining clean hands and fingernails and the moderate use of cosmetics.
- The nature of the work.
- Safety considerations, such as necessary precautions when working near machinery.
- Safety considerations in attire, specifically working at project sites where no loose or flowy clothing is allowed. Scarfs, Hijab or turbans should be properly tucked away should employees choose to wear them.
- The nature of the employee's public contact, if any, and the normal expectations of outside parties with whom the employee will work.
- The prevailing practices of other workers in similar jobs, e.g. appropriate PPE where required.
- Any bandage worn must be kept clean and changed as often as necessary or appropriate. An employee with an open sore or wound is not permitted to handle any food products and may be restricted from other activities, especially in the health care area.

1.16. **Inappropriate or Unacceptable Attire:**

The following attire is considered inappropriate and should not be worn:

- Any clothing that is ripped, stained, or has offensive writing/pictures/logos.
- Loose or flowing clothing that may create a safety hazard while operating equipment, climbing, working at heights, or performing field duties is not permitted. This includes garments that could become entangled in machinery or tools. Reasonable accommodation will be made for religious or medical attire, provided such accommodation does not compromise safety requirements.
- Specifically, while dealing with customers, no hats and caps, in particular the ones worn backwards which give a very casual and laid-back look.
- Sweatpants, spandex, or other athletic-type clothing.
- Shorts/miniskirts.

- T-shirts, muscle shirts, tank tops, spaghetti straps, crop tops, graphic t-shirts.
- Exposed undergarments (e.g., bras, girdles, camisoles, boxer shorts, or any undergarments).
- Flip-flops.

While our goal is to provide a workplace environment that is comfortable and inclusive for all, employees are expected to be mindful of their coworkers and the professional image they present to customers. Professionalism and courtesy should always be the guiding principles in determining whether attire is appropriate.

1.17. **Facial Hair Policy**

To maintain a professional appearance and ensure compliance with health, safety, and hygiene standards, the following guidelines apply to facial hair in the workplace:

1. General Grooming Standards

- Facial hair must be clean, neatly groomed, and well-maintained.
- Styles that are excessively unkempt are not permitted.

2. Safety and PPE Compliance

- Employees required to wear personal protective equipment (PPE), must ensure facial hair does not interfere with the proper fit and function of the equipment.

3. Hygiene

- Employees with facial hair are expected to maintain good hygiene practices, including regular grooming and conditioning.

4. Religious and Medical Exceptions

- Reasonable accommodations will be made for facial hair worn for religious or medical reasons, provided it does not compromise safety standards.

5. Discretion and Enforcement

- Supervisors and HR reserve the right to address facial hair that does not meet these standards.

- Employees will be notified and given reasonable time to comply with grooming expectations.

1.18. **Work Schedules**

Work schedules for employees vary throughout our organization depending on the position, the season and customer needs. Due to fluctuating application schedules, we must remain flexible in the hours and days we work.

Generally, the workweek for employees is Sunday through Saturday. The workday for all employees is from 9:00 AM to 5:00 PM. However, some categories of employees are required to be available on weekends as well as nighttime, details of which will be specified in your individual employment contract.

Employee work schedules are generally established within this framework. When required, an employee's normal work schedule may be somewhat shorter or longer.

You will be advised of your daily starting time. Employees are expected to be at their assigned work areas, ready to begin work, when work commences.

Staffing needs and operational demands may necessitate variations in starting and ending times, as well as variations in the total hours that may be scheduled each day and week or during a period when a project requires overtime.

Your supervisor will notify you of your work schedule.

1.19. **Overtime**

Nonexempt¹ employees will be paid in accordance with federal and Illinois state law.

In Illinois, with some exceptions, the standard work week for nonexempt employees should not exceed 40 hours per week. Should the Company find it necessary to employ an employee more than this standard, overtime hours shall be compensated for at the rate of one and one-half times the regular rate of pay.

All overtime work by nonexempt employees must be authorized in advance by their manager. Only hours worked will be used to calculate overtime pay

At times, and due to the nature of the business, especially with the field engineering, workflow changes rapidly from month to month. There are months when employees need to work round the clock and then days when there's practically no work. Employees are required to adjust accordingly.

¹ Nonexempt Employees are employees whose positions do not meet specific tests established by the FLSA and Illinois state law. All employees who are covered by the federal or state minimum wage and overtime laws are considered nonexempt. Employees working in nonexempt jobs are entitled to be paid at least the minimum wage per hour and a premium for overtime.

This policy is in place to ensure fairness and consistency across all employees. Overtime is intended to compensate for additional hours worked beyond the standard 40-hour work week, and not as a substitute for regular workdays.

By making this adjustment, we aim to balance project delivery expectations with employee availability and maintain operational integrity during high-demand periods

As an example, the 4th quarter is quite busy but there are months like February and March when things are quite slow.

1.20. **Safety**

Risk management practices and safe work habits must be always practiced. Corporate vehicles, personal vehicles (when used on Company time or during Company events), products, equipment, devices, fixtures, etc., should be guarded and carefully handled as effectively as their practical use will permit.

Most injuries to office workers are back injuries due to improper lifting. Use the buddy system lifting items such as computers, printers, heavy boxes. Horseplay, thoughtlessness, loose clothing, slips, falls and improper use of machines are the most frequent causes of injury and death to workers. You are also responsible for the safety of others. It is your duty to obey safety rules and regulations and take every reasonable precaution to avoid injury to yourself and others. You should report any on-the-job injury, regardless of how small it may seem, to your manager as soon as possible and complete a written Accident / Incident Report. Unsafe work conditions or injuries should be reported to your manager.

1.21. **Computer Use policy and transmitted data**

Electronic communications are provided to employees for conducting official business. These systems include email and Internet access. Employees are required to use email resources responsibly and abide by normal standards of professional and personal courtesy and conduct, always. Inappropriate use of email systems and the Internet may be a basis for disciplinary action. Examples of inappropriate use include, but are not limited to the following:

- Using the resources in a way that may be disruptive, offensive to others, harmful to morale or in any way violates other the Company policies including non-discrimination, sexual harassment, conflict of interest, and code of ethics policies
- Displaying messages considered offensive such as those containing comments that offensively address someone's age, race, color, sex, marital status, sexual orientation, religious or political beliefs, national origin or disability
- Distributing or storing chain letters, jokes, solicitations, offers to buy or sell goods, invitations to join or participate in non-Company organizations or events, or other non-business material

- Using the resources for personal non-Company use including social networking, personal email accounts, websites not related to the Company and its holdings or any other form of entertainment or commerce.

Employees are reminded that passwords to their computers are to be memorized and not shared with other employees. Passwords, logins, security codes, etc. are to be stored or kept private and minimize the risk of company proprietary information being leaked or stolen. Employees should also respect the copyright laws of software and are prohibited from loading any software on a Company computer without the knowledge and permission of the Corporate IT manager.

Note: Teams operating out of Pakistan must not access any customer or governmental link under any circumstances. Access must always be coordinated by their manager and must be via Accessing a US based AmeriCloud server. Any employee found in violation with or without their manager's approval will be subject to disciplinary action, which may lead to termination.

1.22. Desks, Lockers, and File Cabinets

AmeriCloud Telecom or its clients may from time to time provide office space, desks, computers or file cabinets, or locker space for employee use at work, in the performance of employment responsibilities.

However, the Company has the right to remove any lock and will not responsible for loss, damage or misplacement of any item placed in any office space, locker, desk, file cabinet or computer, or otherwise brought to the Company or client premises or on the Company's premises, that is lost, damaged, stolen or destroyed.

Weapons, explosives, alcohol and drugs are strictly prohibited on Company or client premises and may not be placed in any office space, locker, desk or file cabinet.

Employees have no privacy rights in any office space, locker, desk, file cabinet or computer (or their contents) on Company or client property or provided by The Company or a client of the Company. The Company reserves the right to inspect any such office space, locker, desk, file cabinet, computer, and their contents, and any other place or item on the Company's or client property, with or without advance notice or consent of any employee. Any person designated by the Company or client may conduct such an inspection. Any employee who, upon request, fails or refuses to cooperate with any such inspection may be subject to disciplinary action, up to and including termination of employment.

1.23. Parking

Parking is provided to employees on the Company's property at no cost to the employee. Employees should avoid double-parking or parking in unauthorized spaces. Additionally, the Company assumes no responsibility for theft, break-ins, or other acts of vandalism to

employees' cars when left on the premises after normal business hours, when employee is not on official company business.

While on official duty, employees will be reimbursed for parking charges on presenting original receipts.

1.24. Company Video Surveillance Policy

Guidelines have been established for video surveillance to safeguard the Company and its employees. This policy may be adjusted at any time based on geographical location, network access, surveillance delivery method, systems capabilities or other factors.

1.25. Cell Phone Policy

The use of personal cell phones at work is discouraged because it can interfere with work and be disruptive to others. Therefore, employees who bring personal cell phones to work are required to keep the ringer shut off or placed on vibrate mode when they are in the office and keep cell phone use confined to breaks and meal periods.

The privilege of using a personal cell phone at work may be taken away, if this is found to be distracting for the employee themselves or their colleagues.

The Company may provide cell phone or cell phone allowances to employees in certain positions to improve efficiency and effectiveness. When cell phones are used for Company business, employees must comply with all Company policies governing conduct, including our policies prohibiting discrimination, harassment, and violence in the workplace. When using the cell phone in a public place, please remember to maintain the confidentiality of any private or confidential business information. As a courtesy to others, please shut cell phones off or place them on vibrate mode during meetings.

Moreover, it is strictly prohibited to download social media apps, lifestyle apps, consumer apps, personal platforms, digital leisure tools and utility apps for personal use on Company provided cell phones as this affects not only cost but performance of the device. Any employee found in violation will be subject to disciplinary action, which may lead to termination.

1.26. Personal Computer Use Policy

Employees are reminded that passwords to their computers are to be memorized and not shared with other employees. Employees should also respect the copyright laws of software and are prohibited from loading any software on the Company computer without the written permission of an "authorized person."

The Company owns all Company-supplied systems and software that employees may be authorized to use. Employees are not permitted to make any changes of any kind to Company equipment without the express written permission of the IT Manager. Additionally,

remote access client services (i.e. Log me in, Team Viewer, etc.) may not be installed or used at any time.

All information created, stored, sent or received using any of the Company computers, email and/or Internet systems are the sole property of the Company. The Company reserves the right to monitor, intercept and review, without further notice, every employee's activity using the Company's IT resources and communications systems, including but not limited to e-mail (both outgoing and incoming), telephone conversations and voice mail recordings, instant messages and internet and social media postings and activities. Employees must, and you consent to such monitoring by your acknowledgement of this policy and your use of such resources and systems. This might include, without limitation, the monitoring, interception, accessing, recording, disclosing, inspecting, reviewing, retrieving and printing of transactions, messages, communications, postings, logins, recordings and other uses of the systems as well as keystroke capturing and other network monitoring technologies. Do not use the Company's IT resources and communications systems for any matter that you desire to be kept private or confidential from the Company.

Use of passwords or other security measures does not in any way reduce the Company's right to access materials on its systems nor does it create any privacy rights for the users in the messages and files on any of the Company systems.

The Company reserves the right to view, modify and/or delete any software, information, messages or attachments at its discretion, regardless of whether such information meets the qualifications outlined in this policy, or whether the information adversely impacts the proper and efficient operation of the system.

Additionally, it is strictly prohibited to download social media apps, lifestyle apps, consumer apps, personal platforms, digital leisure tools and utility apps for personal use on Company provided Laptops as this effects not only cost but performance of the device. Any employee found in non-compliance will be subject to disciplinary action, which may lead to termination.

A complete copy of the Internet Usage Policy must be signed by each employee. Employees are responsible for understanding the Company's complete policy regarding internet use and that a violation of this policy may result in disciplinary action up to and including termination of employment.

1.27. **Social Media Policy**

Social media includes all means of communicating or posting information or content of any sort on the Internet, including to your own or someone else's web log or blog, journal or diary, personal web site, social networking or affinity web site, web bulletin board or a chat room, whether or not employed or affiliated with the Company, as well as any other form of electronic communication. Ultimately, you are solely responsible for what you post online. Before creating online content, consider some of the risks and rewards that are involved. Keep in mind that any of your conducts that adversely affect your job performance, the performance of fellow employees or otherwise adversely affects members, customers, suppliers, people who work on behalf of the Company or the Company's legitimate business

interests may result in disciplinary action up to and including termination. All employees of the Company must know and comply with the rules:

All the Company's other policies that might apply to use social media remain in full force and effect. Employees should always adhere to them when using social media. In particular, the following policies should be kept in mind: PC Use Policy, Anti-Discrimination Policy, Anti-Harassment Policy, and Anti-Retaliation Policy.

Inappropriate postings that may include discriminatory or derogatory remarks against employees or the Company, harassment, and threats of violence or similar inappropriate or unlawful conduct will not be tolerated and may subject you to disciplinary action up to and including termination.

Defaming the Company or its employees or posting derogatory comments on social media can have serious consequences, both legally and professionally. From a legal standpoint, spreading false or damaging statements may lead to defamation lawsuits, resulting in financial penalties, compensation claims, or even criminal liability depending on jurisdiction. Professionally, individuals who engage in defamation risk damaging their own reputation, losing credibility, and facing disciplinary action from employers or industry bodies. For the company itself, in severe cases, it may also trigger regulatory scrutiny or long-term reputational damage that is difficult to repair.

Always be fair and courteous to fellow employees, customers, members, suppliers or people who work on behalf of the Company. Also, keep in mind that you are more likely to resolve work-related complaints by speaking directly with your co-workers or supervisor than by posting complaints to a social media outlet. Nevertheless, if you decide to post complaints or criticism, avoid using statements, photographs, video or audio that reasonably could be viewed as malicious, obscene, threatening or intimidating, that disparage customers, members, employees or suppliers, or that might constitute harassment or bullying. Examples of such conduct might include offensive posts meant to intentionally harm someone's reputation or posts that could contribute to a hostile work environment based on race, sex, disability, religion or any other status protected by law or Company policy.

Make sure you are always honest and accurate when posting information or news, and if you make a mistake, correct it quickly. Be open about any previous posts you have altered. Remember that the Internet archives almost everything; therefore, even deleted postings can be searched. Never post any information or rumors that you know to be false about the Company, fellow employees, members, customers, suppliers, people working on behalf of the Company, or competitors.

Post only appropriate and respectful content. Maintain the confidentiality of the Company trade secrets and private or confidential information. Do not post internal reports, policies, procedures or other internal business-related confidential communications. Do not create a link from your blog, website or other social networking site to a Company website without identifying yourself as a Company employee. Express only your personal opinions. Never represent yourself as a spokesperson for the Company. If the Company is a subject of the content you are creating, be clear and open about the fact that you are an employee and make it clear that your views do not represent those of the Company, fellow employees,

members, customers, suppliers or people working on behalf of the Company. If you do publish a blog or post online related to the work you do or subjects employed with the Company, make it clear that you are not speaking on behalf of the Company. It is best to include a disclaimer such as "The postings on this site are my own and do not necessarily reflect the views of the Company."

SECTION 2 - Employment Status and Records

2.1. Employment Categories

It is the intent of the Company to clarify the definitions of employment classifications so that employees understand their employment status and benefit eligibility. These classifications do not guarantee employment for any specified period. The right to terminate the employment relationship "at will" is retained by both the employee and the Company.

Each employee is designated as either *NONEXEMPT* or *EXEMPT* from federal and state wage and hour laws. *NONEXEMPT* employees are entitled to overtime pay under the specific provisions of federal and state laws. *EXEMPT* employees are excluded from specific provisions of federal and state wage and hour laws. An employee's *EXEMPT* or *NONEXEMPT* classification may be changed only upon written notification by the Company management and administered through the Human Resources Department.

In addition to the above categories, each employee will belong to one of the following employment categories:

- Regular Full-Time: Employees are those who are not in temporary or introductory status and who are regularly scheduled to work (40 hours a week) the Company's full-time schedule. Generally, they can be eligible for the Company's benefit package, subject to the terms, conditions, and limitations of each benefit program and the discretion of the corporate management team.
- Part-Time: Employees are those who are not assigned to a temporary or introductory status and are those who are regularly scheduled to work less than 40 hours per week.

The employment category will clearly be stated in the employment contract which each employee is required to sign in acceptance.

2.2. Remote Working

Remote work is a privilege and not a guaranteed right. All arrangements are subject to approval and may be modified or revoked at the sole discretion of the Company.

2.2.1 Eligibility and Approval

Remote work eligibility is determined based on:

Job responsibilities
Operational and client requirements
Performance history
Security and compliance considerations

Not all positions are eligible for remote work. Roles requiring in-person customer interaction, field engineering, equipment handling, or on-site operational duties may require physical presence.

All remote work arrangements must be approved in writing by the employee Manager and the Human Resources Department.

2.2.2 Work Hours and Availability

Employees approved for remote work must:

Maintain their assigned work schedule (generally 9:00 AM – 5:00 PM CST or corresponding local time unless otherwise approved). Be accessible during scheduled work hours via approved Company communication platforms. Attend required virtual meetings and respond to communications in a timely and professional manner. Non-exempt employees must accurately record all hours worked in accordance with Company timekeeping policies. Overtime must be pre-approved in writing.

2.2.3 Work Location

Remote employees must perform their duties from an approved work location. Any change in remote work address must be reported to and approved by Management and the Human Resources Department in advance. Employees are responsible for maintaining a secure, professional, and distraction-free workspace. Remote work from public or unsecured locations while handling confidential Company or customer information is prohibited unless expressly authorized.

2.2.4 Equipment and Technology

The Company may provide equipment such as laptops, mobile devices, or secure access credentials necessary to perform job duties remotely.

All Company-issued equipment remains Company property and must be:

- Used strictly for business purposes
- Safeguarded against damage or theft
- Returned upon request or termination of employment

Employees must comply with all Company IT, cybersecurity, and data protection policies.

2.2.5 Data Security and Confidentiality

Remote employees are required to comply with all Company confidentiality, information security, and IT policies.

Employees must:

- Use secure networks and approved systems
- Protect confidential customer, vendor, and employee information
- Prevent unauthorized access to Company systems

Any suspected data breach, security concern, or loss of Company information must be reported immediately.

2.2.6 Workplace Safety and Workers' Compensation

Employees are responsible for maintaining a safe homework environment. Work-related injuries occurring during approved work hours and at the approved work location must be reported immediately in accordance with Company safety and incident reporting procedures. Workers' compensation coverage applies only to injuries arising out of and in the course of employment.

2.2.7 Expenses

Unless otherwise required by law or expressly approved in advance, the Company does not reimburse routine home office expenses such as internet service, utilities, or furniture. Pre-approved business expenses will be reimbursed in accordance with the Company's Expense Reimbursement Policy.

2.2.8 Performance and Compliance

Employees working remotely are held to the same performance, conduct, and productivity standards as on-site employees.

Failure to meet performance expectations, maintain communication standards, comply with Company policies, or adhere to security requirements may result in disciplinary action and/or revocation of remote work privileges.

2.2.9 Modification or Revocation

The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend, or terminate remote work arrangements at any time based on business needs, performance concerns, compliance requirements, or operational factors.

2.3. Reference Checks

The Company may require employment references, background check, criminal check or credit check to make a more intelligent decision at selecting qualified personnel. The Company reserves the right to require additional documentation concerning employment/background references of prospective or current applicants.

2.4. **Personnel Data Changes**

Each employee is responsible for notifying the Company of any changes in personnel data. Personal mailing addresses, telephone numbers, number and names of dependents, emergency contact information, educational accomplishments, marital status, driving record or status of driver's license, military or draft status, beneficiary changes and other such status reports should be accurate and current at all times. If any personnel data has changed, employees are required to immediately inform Human Resources department.

2.5. **Next of Kin Information**

Each employee is required to provide details of their Next of Kin, i.e. closest living relative e.g. spouse, child, parent, or sibling. It is strongly encouraged to provide any updates to your next of kin (nearest relatives) information, for emergency and administrative purposes.

Why does AmeriCloud ask for next of kin details:

- *Emergency contact purposes:* If an employee is injured, falls ill, or is involved in an accident at work.
- *Death in service procedures:* To notify family and manage benefits, insurance claims, or final payments.
- *Legal or administrative requirements:* for purposes of completeness and compliance of personnel records.

Employee Responsibilities

- *Providing accurate information:* While not legally mandatory, employees are typically expected to provide next of kin (nearest relatives) details voluntarily during onboarding or HR updates.
- *Keeping it current:* Employees should update this information if their family situation changes (e.g., marriage, divorce, death).
- *Understanding its use:* Employees should be aware that this information is used for contact in emergencies or sensitive situations, not for legal decision-making unless otherwise authorized.

The Company handles next of kin (nearest relative) data in compliance with data protection laws (e.g., GDPR, HIPAA), ensuring it is stored securely and only accessed when necessary.

2.6. Probationary Period

The probationary period is intended to analyze and improve the performance of newly hired employees as well as to allow employees the opportunity to demonstrate their ability to achieve a satisfactory level of performance. The Company uses this period to evaluate employee capabilities, work habits, overall performance. Either the employee or the Company may end the employment relationship “at will” at any time during or after the probationary period, with or without cause or advance notice.

All new and rehired employees work on a 90-day probationary basis after their date of hire. Reviews will be conducted on an ‘as needed’ basis. If the Company determines that the designated probationary period does not allow sufficient time to thoroughly evaluate the employee’s performance, it may extend the probationary period for another designated period.

Upon satisfactory completion of the initial probationary period, employees enter the “regular” full-time or part-time employment classification or as the case may be.

During the initial probationary period, new employees are eligible for those benefits that are required by law and made available to them by the Company, such as Worker’s Compensation Insurance and Social Security. Once you successfully complete your probation and become a regular employee, you may be eligible for additional Company-provided benefits. Eligibility for these benefits is subject to the specific terms and conditions of your employment contract and each benefit program and is determined at the sole discretion of management.

2.7. Employment Applications

The Company relies on the accuracy of information contained in the employment application, as well as the accuracy of other data presented throughout the hiring process and throughout ongoing employment. Any misrepresentations, falsifications, or material omissions in any of this information or data may result in the exclusion of the individual from further consideration for employment or, if the person has been hired, termination of employment.

2.8. Chain of Supervision, Authority and Responsibility

Day to day issues, problems, questions and concerns not specifically covered by this Handbook shall be addressed with the employee’s immediate supervisor. Employees will have a direct report supervisor, or manager that they must report to on a daily basis. In the absence of a supervisor or manager, employees are to contact the next level supervisor in the chain of command.

As an employee, it is imperative that the hierarchy of the Company be respected and protected. To that end employees will be under the direct supervision and direction of an appointed supervisor/manager. Employees will follow the directions given during working hours and comply with Company guidelines.

Each manager is held accountable for the performance and actions of employees under their immediate supervision. Managers may delegate daily tasks to employees and/or designate an employee as the person-in-charge; however, the manager is ultimately responsible for their department.

Any questions regarding hierarchy can be directed to the Human Resources Department.

2.9. **Travel and Hotel Arrangements for Employees with Company Credit Card**

When traveling for work with a Company Credit Card, employees must keep arrangements simple, professional, and cost-effective. All flights, hotels, rental cars, and related travel expenses must be booked through the Company's approved travel portal in accordance with the *AmeriCloud Telecom Company Travel Policy*. Employees are expected to comply fully with the current Travel Policy, including booking requirements, cost limits, documentation standards, and reimbursement timelines.

Employees must select economy airfare and standard hotel accommodations unless prior written approval for an upgrade is obtained from Management in accordance with the Travel Policy.

The Company Credit Card may be used strictly for authorized business-related expenses, including transportation, lodging, and approved meals. Personal purchases are strictly prohibited. All itemized receipts must be retained and submitted in accordance with the expense reporting requirements outlined in the Company Travel Policy.

Personal meals are defined as expenses incurred by an employee traveling outside of their assigned base location for approved work assignments or projects. Meal allowances, per diem options, and applicable limits are governed by the current Company Travel Policy.

The Company reserves the right to modify meal allowances or travel expense limits based on operational or business needs. Any such changes will be communicated in writing and will be reflected in the updated Travel Policy.

- Meals and lodging expenses are covered only when the employee is traveling away from their designated base location. Please refer to your offer letter and the current Travel Policy for eligibility details.
- Meals with clients must be paid by the highest-level manager present unless otherwise approved. The names of attendees and the business purpose must be clearly documented on the receipt. Original itemized receipts are required for Company Credit Card charges or reimbursement submissions.

All travel expenses are subject to review and approval. Failure to comply with the Company Travel Policy may result in denial of reimbursement, revocation of Company Credit Card privileges, and/or disciplinary action, up to and including termination of employment.

2.10. **Company Vehicle and Equipment Usage & Responsibility Policy**

Employees are allowed to make direct or Online car rentals reservations under their name as long as rental fee represents a compact car and the lowest logical price. Any other form of transportation such as Taxi, Lyft, Uber is also acceptable if it is the most logical form of transportation. Any employee required to use their own automobile for business will be reimbursed at the prevailing rate per tax guidelines for per mile deduction. The Company assumes no responsibility for personal automobiles used for business. Further, any parking or speeding violations is the sole responsibility of the employee.

As far as possible, employees are encouraged to travel together by carpooling or jointly renting vehicles thus reducing fuel and rental expenditures. Field Engineers in training or shadowing experienced field engineers, are not eligible for mileage expenses. Wherever possible, such trainees are required to travel together with their seniors in one vehicle.

All expenses to be reimbursed will require original Receipts.

The Company may also book travel arrangements, hotel accommodation and car rental on behalf of employee in some circumstances which would be booked with company credit card & reimbursement will only be made for other approved factors such as; parking, client lunch/dinners etc., where applicable. Any other expenses not outlined in these policies shall not be reimbursed unless approved by CEO/CFO in advance. Employees are required to follow all policies and guidelines established for expense reimbursement. Any question regarding completion of the reports should be directed to the employee's supervisor or HR Manager. All non-compliant charges will be rejected; exceptions will be reviewed & approved by CEO/CFO. All expenditure must be accompanied by scanned receipts &/or supporting documentation. *ANY EXPENSES THAT ARE SUBMITTED FOR REIMBURSEMENT WHICH ARE PAST ONE MONTH OCCURRENCE DATE WILL NOT BE REIMBURSED.*

Authorized Use

- Company-provided and rental vehicles are to be used exclusively for business purposes.
 - Personal use of any company assets, including vehicles, is strictly prohibited.

Vehicle Care and Return

- Employees must return vehicles in a clean, orderly condition.
- Any fines, penalties, or charges incurred due to misuse or abuse of vehicles will be the employee's responsibility.

Smoking Restrictions

- Smoking is prohibited at all times:
 - Within Company premises
 - At customer sites
 - Inside company-provided or rental vehicles

Driving Conduct and Safety

- Employees are expected to exercise reasonable care and caution when operating company-provided or rental vehicles.
- All accidents, regardless of severity, must be reported immediately to HR and the employee's manager, accompanied by supporting evidence, together with the Accident and Incident form duly completed.
- If an accident is determined to be the result of employee negligence, the cost of repairs will be recovered from the employee.

Liability for Damages

- Employees are financially responsible for damages to Company or rental vehicles when liability is established due to negligence, misconduct, or violation of policy.
- Compliance with traffic laws and safe driving practices is mandatory.

Handling Sensitive Equipment

- Sensitive equipment (e.g., scanners, fragile devices) must be carried in hand luggage and not checked in when traveling.
- When shipping such equipment, employees must ensure proper packaging and preparation to safeguard against damage.

Consequences of Non-Compliance

Failure to adhere to this policy may result in:

- Recovery of costs for damages, fines, or penalties
- Formal disciplinary action, including written warnings or suspension
- In cases of repeated or serious violations, termination of employment

2.11. **Performance Evaluation**

Managers and employees are strongly encouraged to discuss job performance and goals on an informal, day-to-day basis. A formal written performance evaluation may be conducted at the end of an employee's probationary period. Additional performance evaluations are conducted to provide both managers and employees with the opportunity to discuss job tasks, identify and correct weaknesses, encourage and recognize strengths, discuss positive behaviors, and purposeful approaches for meeting goals.

Normally performance evaluations are scheduled approximately every 12 months. However, Management retains the right to perform interim evaluations at any time, with or without notice, at its own discretion utilizing documented or undocumented correspondence.

Merit-based pay adjustments are awarded by the Company in an effort to recognize truly superior employee performance. The decision to award such an adjustment is dependent

upon numerous factors, including but not limited to the information documented by the performance evaluation process.

Performance evaluation is not solely commensurate on performance. Adhering to all Company policies and procedures, and scarcity of skillset is also factored in the overall evaluation.

SECTION 3 - Employment Benefit Programs

3.1. Employee Benefits

Besides those benefits required by state and federal regulations, AmeriCloud Telecom also offers additional benefits for its full-time employees. From time to time, benefits may be added or deleted. The Company reserves the right to make such changes as it deems necessary.

This Handbook does not contain the complete terms and/or conditions of any of the Company's current benefit plans. It is intended only to provide general purview. For further details, please contact Human Resources.

Eligible Company employees are provided our wide range of benefits as detailed below.

Benefits eligibility is dependent upon a variety of factors, including employee classification, tenure, current employment status and the sole discretion of the Management. For further details contact the Human Resources Department.

3.2. Group Health Insurance

The Company offers group health plans for eligible employees.

3.3. Group Life Insurance

The Company offers a group life insurance plan for eligible employees, including accidental death and dismemberment coverage.

3.4. 401(K) Plan

AmeriCloud Telecom's 401(k) Plan is a convenient payroll deductible method to help supplement employees' retirement benefits and provide a long-term vehicle to accumulate savings. For information regarding employee benefits and services, employees should contact Human Resources.

3.5. COBRA

Under the provisions of the Consolidated Omnibus Budget Reconciliation Act (COBRA) of 1986, if you are covered under the Company's group health insurance plan(s) you are entitled to continue your coverage if your employment with the Company ends. Under COBRA, the Company must offer each qualified beneficiary (the employee and any covered dependents) who would otherwise lose coverage under the plan as a result of a qualifying

event an opportunity to continue their insurance coverage. A qualifying event is defined as termination of employment, a reduction in the number of hours of employment, death of covered employee, divorce or legal separation, a dependent child ceases to be dependent, eligibility of the covered employee for Medicare, or an employer's bankruptcy.

3.6. Workers' Compensation

The Company provides a comprehensive worker's compensation insurance program at no cost to the employee in the state they are assigned. This program covers any injury or illness sustained in the course of employment that requires medical, surgical, or hospital treatment. Subject to applicable legal requirements, worker's compensation insurance provides benefits after a short waiting period or if the employee is hospitalized immediately. Employees who sustain work-related injuries or illnesses should inform their manager immediately and complete a written incident report. This form should be returned to the Human Resources Department within 24 hours of the incident. No matter how minor an on-the-job injury may appear, it is important that it be reported immediately. This will enable an eligible employee to qualify for coverage as quickly as possible.

Neither the Company nor the insurance carrier will be liable for the payment of worker's compensation benefits for injuries that occur during an employee's voluntary participation in any off-duty recreational, social, or athletic activity sponsored by the Company, its vendors, or partners.

The Company asks for employees' assistance in alerting the Human Resources Department to any condition that could lead or contribute to an employee accident. The Company will abide by all requirements set forth by the Workers' Compensation Act and any other applicable law. The Company will not take any adverse action against an employee in retaliation for filing a workers' compensation claim.

3.7. Social Security Benefits (FICA)

During your employment, you and the Company both contribute funds to the federal government to support the Social Security Program. This program is intended to provide you with retirement benefit payments and medical coverage once you reach retirement age.

3.8. Unemployment Insurance

The Company pays a state and federal tax to provide employees with unemployment insurance coverage in the event they become unemployed through no fault of their own or due to circumstances described by law. This insurance is administered by applicable state agencies, who determine eligibility for benefits, the number of benefits (if any), and duration of benefits.

3.9. Dental Insurance

All full-time employees become eligible to participate in the Company's dental plan on the first day of the month following 30 days of consecutive employment and satisfaction of any eligibility or other requirements of the applicable dental policy in effect at the time. Upon

qualification for dental insurance benefit, you will be given the applicable documentation and details of what options are available to you.

3.10. **Holidays**

The company recognizes and observes the following holidays. Employees are compensated for these holidays when the company is closed at their current base rate. There is no additional compensation for working on holidays, except when hours worked exceed 40 hours for non-exempt employees. The company reserves the right to modify the paid holidays at its discretion. In addition to the below, there are three (3) floating holidays per calendar year.

- New Year's Day
- Memorial Day
- Fourth of July
- Labor Day
- Thanksgiving Day
- Christmas Day

3.11. **Training and Development**

New employees need to acquire the skills, knowledge, and abilities necessary to proficiently perform their jobs. Existing employees may need additional training to ensure ongoing quality assurance and/or to correct behaviors in need of a change. The Company believes in promoting from within the Company whenever possible, consequently we may provide opportunities for training and development for those employees demonstrating the ability and desire to advance their career. All employees that are required to participate in external and/or internal training must comply as designated.

NOTE: Any benefits or benefit plans described in these policies are convenient summaries only. An employee's eligibility for or rights to any benefits will be subject to and governed by the governing benefit plan documents and applicable law, as either may be amended from time to time. The Company reserves to itself and to any administrator or fiduciary of any benefit or benefit plan described or referred to in this handbook (or any other benefit or benefit plan) of AmeriCloud Telecom Solutions the discretionary authority to determine eligibility of any employee or claimant for or under any such benefit or plan, pursuant to the terms of the relevant plan document and applicable law, as either may be amended from time to time, and to interpret and construe the terms of any such benefit or plan. The Company reserves the right to, at any time add, amend, modify, supplement or terminate any benefit, benefit plan or employee benefit. For answers to any questions, you may have regarding any benefit or benefit plan, first refer to the applicable plan documents. For additional assistance, you may contact the plan administrator listed in the plan documents.

SECTION 4 - Timekeeping and Payroll

4.1. Timekeeping

Federal and state laws require that the Company keep an accurate record of hours worked for non-exempt employees to calculate correct pay and benefits.

Employees are responsible for accurately recording the time they begin and end a shift, the beginning and ending time of each meal period and/or break, and the beginning and ending time of any split shift or departure from work for personal reasons. Employees (unless exempted) are required to use the timesheet to accurately and consistently document all hours worked. All "manual" timesheets entries must be verified by the supervisor or manager. Altering, falsifying, tampering with time records, or recording time on another employee's time record may result in disciplinary action, up to and including termination as well as recovery of lost company assets.

4.2. Overtime

Instances may arise requiring the need to work overtime. When this circumstance occurs, overtime must be authorized in advance by your supervisor. Employees are expected to make full accommodations to work overtime, when necessary, as directed by management. Nonexempt employees will be paid in accordance with federal and state law.

In Illinois, with some exceptions, the standard work week for nonexempt employees should not exceed 40 hours per week. Should the Company find it necessary to employ an employee in excess of this standard, overtime hours shall be compensated for at the rate of one and one-half times the regular rate of pay.

All overtime work by nonexempt employees must be authorized in advance by their respective supervisors. Only hours worked will be used to calculate overtime pay.

Overtime is required based on the Company's operational needs, as determined by your supervisor. Employees must understand and accommodate the possibility of overtime as part of their job responsibilities. All overtime hours worked must be paid at the statutory premium rate for non-exempt employees, by the Federal Wage and Hour Law.

4.3. Paydays

Employees are paid on a Semi-monthly basis. All employees will be paid on the 15th and the last day of the month. All employees are paid by check or direct deposit on the above-mentioned payday. If the regular payday falls on a weekend or Company holiday, employees will be paid on the last business day before the holiday and/or weekend.

4.4. Meal Periods and Rest Breaks

The Company will provide rest and meal periods in accordance with applicable federal and

state law. Federal law does not require employers to provide meal or rest breaks; however, if breaks are offered, certain federal wage-and-hour standards will apply.

Where state law mandates specific breaks, the Company will comply with those requirements.

For example:

- In *California*, employees working more than 5 hours are generally entitled to a 30-minute unpaid meal period, and additional rest and meal periods may be required for longer shifts. Paid rest breaks are also required for every four hours worked (or major fraction thereof) when applicable.
- In *Illinois*, employees scheduled to work more than 7.5 continuous hours will be provided with a 20-minute unpaid meal period no later than five hours after the beginning of the shift.
- In *Texas*, there is no statutory requirement for employers to provide meal or rest periods; however, any short rest breaks offered (typically 20 minutes or less) will be treated as paid time in accordance with federal wage-and-hour law.

Employees should consult with Human Resources if they have specific questions about how meal and rest periods apply in their work location.

4.5. Time Cards

Nonexempt employees are required to keep an accurate and complete record of their attendance and hours worked. Timecards are official business records and may not be altered without the employee's supervisor's approval and may not be falsified in any way.

4.6. Lactation Breaks

As part of our family-friendly policies and benefits, the Company supports breastfeeding mothers by accommodating the mother who wishes to express breast milk during her workday when separated from her newborn child.

For up to one year after the child's birth, any employee who is breastfeeding her child will be provided with reasonable break times to express breast milk for her baby. The Company will provide employees with a designated location for this purpose.

Breaks of more than 20 minutes in length will be unpaid, and the employee should indicate this break period on their time record.

4.7. Employment Termination

Changes in employment status are a routine function of personnel activity. Examples of common status designations under which employment is terminated include:

- *Resignation*: voluntary employment termination initiated by an employee.

- *Discharge:* involuntary employment termination initiated by the organization.
- *Retirement:* voluntary employment termination initiated by the employee meeting age, length of service, and any other criteria for retirement from the organization.

The Company schedules exit interviews to improve employee relations, discuss reasons for termination, review employee benefits, and discuss restitution, outstanding debts, return of Company-owned property or intellectual rights, etc.

Because the Company is an “at-will” employer, employee benefits are affected by employment termination in the following manner:

- All vested benefits due and deemed payable at the time of termination will be paid
- Some benefits may be continued at the employee’s expense under COBRA rules
- Employees will be notified of benefits that may be continued, as well as terms, conditions, and limitations.

4.8. Expense Reimbursements, Adjustments and Administrative Pay Corrections

To ensure accurate and prompt reimbursements, adjustments and other payroll distributions, when scheduled, employees are required to adhere to the following procedures:

- Proper administrative processes, forms, identification, signatures, and authorizations must be submitted
- Pre-approvals must be verified, in current good standing, orderly, and timely submitted
- All expenses and adjustments must be pre-approved by an authorized supervisor
- Receipts are mandatory to ensure timely reimbursement and required for internal record-keeping.

In the event of an error in distribution, employees are required to present the discrepancy to their immediate supervisor to ensure prompt corrections can be made as swiftly as possible.

4.9. Pay Deductions

Various payroll deductions are made each payday to comply with federal and state laws pertaining to taxes and insurance. Deductions will be made for the following:

- Federal and State Income Tax Withholding,
- Social Security,
- Medicare, State Disability Insurance,
- Family Temporary Disability Insurance,
- any other items designated by you or required by law (including a valid court order).

You can adjust your federal and state income tax withholding by completing the proper federal or state form and submitting it to accounting or Human Resources. At the start of each calendar year, you will be supplied with your Wage and Tax Statement (W-2) form for the prior year. This statement summarizes your income and deductions for the year.

4.10. Minimum Wage

The Fair Labor Standards Act (FLSA) requires employers pay their employees a minimum wage. Any employee employed by the Company shall receive at least the federal minimum wage. The current federal minimum wage is \$7.25 per hour worked.

State or local law may vary from federal law. Certain jurisdictions may impose a higher minimum wage. However, these jurisdictions may impose requirements different from those of the FLSA. The Company complies with all federal, state and local laws governing minimum wage.

4.11. Wage Garnishment

A garnishment is a court order requiring an employer to remit part of an employee's wages to a third party to satisfy a just debt. Once the Company receives the legal papers ordering a garnishment, we are required by law to continue making deductions from your check until we have withheld the full amount or until we receive legal papers from the court to stop the garnishment. Even if you have already paid the debt, we still need legal papers to stop the garnishment.

4.12. Direct Deposit

All employees are encouraged, but not required, to use direct deposit and have their paychecks deposited into a bank account of an accredited participating bank or credit union.

4.13. Employment of Minors

The FLSA's child labor provisions, which the Company strictly adheres to, are designed to protect the educational opportunities of youth and prohibit their employment in jobs that are detrimental to their health and safety. The FLSA sets the minimum age for employment (14 years for non-agricultural jobs), restricts the hours youth under the age of 16 may

work, and prohibit youth under the age of 18 from being employed in hazardous occupations.

In addition, FLSA establishes subminimum wage standards for certain employees who are less than 20 years of age, full-time students, student learners, apprentices, and workers with disabilities. Employers generally must have authorization from the U.S. Department of Labor's Wage and Hour Division (WHD) to pay sub-minimum wage rates.

SECTION 5 - Leaves of Absence

5.1. Personal Leave of Absence (excluding FMLA)

The Company values regular attendance as essential to business operations. At the same time, we recognize that employees may occasionally need time away from work. The Company provides several types of leaves of absence; some required by law, others offered at management's discretion.

Request Process

- Planned Leave: Submit requests at least 14 days in advance.
- Emergency Leave: Notify management as soon as possible.
- All leave requests must receive management approval.

Conditions During Leave

- Employees may not:
 - Accept other employment or consulting work.
 - Apply for unemployment insurance benefits.
 - Engage in activities inconsistent with continued employment.
 - Violations may be treated as a voluntary resignation.

Approval and Consideration

- Requests are evaluated based on their impact on business operations.
- The Company reserves the right to approve or deny requests at its sole discretion, unless otherwise required by law.

Medical and Disability Leave

- For disability-related leave requests, the Company will engage in an interactive process to determine appropriate accommodation.

- Employees must provide medical certification from their healthcare provider to support leave for medical reasons.
- Failure to provide timely certification may result in delay or denial of leave.
- Requests for extensions must be submitted and approved before the current leave expires.

Reinstatement

- The Company will make a reasonable effort to return employees to their former or a comparable position following an approved leave.
- Reinstatement is not guaranteed, except where required by law (e.g., Family and Medical Leave Act or disability-related protections).

5.2. Family and Medical Leave Act Policy (FMLA Policy)

Owing to the Company's small size, we are not required to comply with the federal Family and Medical Leave Act (FMLA). However, we recognize that our employees may occasionally need to take unpaid leave to care for a new child, to care for a seriously ill family member, to handle an employee's own medical issues, or to handle issues relating to a family member's military service, possibly including caring for a family member who is injured while serving in the military.

If you anticipate that you might need time off to deal with family and medical issues, please speak with your Human Resources Manager. Each request will be considered on a case-by-case basis.

5.3. State Family and Medical Leaves

An employee of a company with between 15 and 49 employees may qualify for up to eight weeks of unpaid state leave in any 12-month period if the employee or family/household member is a victim of domestic violence or sexual assault. All time off that qualifies as family and medical leave will be counted against the employee's federal and, if applicable, state family and medical leave entitlement to the fullest extent permitted by law.

5.4. Workers Compensation Leave

Any employee who is unable to work due to a work-related injury or illness and who is eligible for Workers' Compensation benefits will be provided an unpaid leave for the period required. The first 12 weeks will be treated concurrently as family and medical leave under the federal Family Medical Leave Act ("FMLA") for employees eligible for FMLA leave.

5.5. Bereavement Leaves

The Company recognizes that the death of a loved one is a difficult time. Bereavement leave provides employees with time away from work to grieve and attend to personal matters.

Eligibility and Duration

- Employees may take up to 5 days of paid bereavement leave for the death of an immediate family member (spouse, child, parent, sibling, grandparent, grandchild, or equivalent in-law/step relation).
- Employees may take 2 days of paid bereavement leave for the death of an extended relative (aunt, uncle, cousin, or other relative not listed above).
- Additional unpaid time off may be requested and considered at management's discretion.

Request Process

- Employees should notify their supervisor as soon as possible after learning of the death.
- Requests should include the relationship to the deceased and the anticipated dates of absence.
- Documentation (such as an obituary or funeral program) may be required.

Conditions

Bereavement leave must be taken consecutively and close to the time of the death or funeral. Employees may request additional unpaid leave or use accrued PTO if more time is needed, subject to manager's approval.

This policy will be administered in accordance with applicable state and local laws.

5.6. Jury Duty

The Company encourages employees to fulfill their civic duties related to jury service. Employees summoned for jury duty are entitled to unpaid time off for the first five (5) days of jury service. For any additional days, employees may use any available accrued paid time off (for example, vacation benefits) or may request additional unpaid jury duty leave of absence.

U.S. citizens have a civic obligation to provide jury duty service when called. By state law, a regular night shift employee will not be required to work if they are serving on a jury during the day. The employee should also, by law, not lose any seniority or benefits for serving jury duty.

The employee must bring in the jury duty notice as soon as it is received so that appropriate arrangements can be made to cover their duties. Employees are required to call in or report for work on those days or parts of days when their presence in court is not required.

Employees are required to submit a 'certificate of attendance, or a stub, or similar document provided by the court, as evidence.

An employee who abuses this policy will be subject to disciplinary action, up to and including termination of employment.

5.7. **Voting Leave**

Employees who are registered voters and whose working hours begin less than two hours after the opening of the polls and end less than two hours before the closing of the polls may take up to two hours off work with pay to vote in any local, state, and national election at a time decided by the employer. Employees should provide notice when time off is required.

5.8. **Military Leave**

A military leave of absence will be granted to employees who are absent from work because of service in the U.S. uniformed armed services in accordance with the Uniformed Services Employment and Reemployment Rights Act (USERRA). Advance notice of military service is required, unless military necessity prevents such notice or it is otherwise impossible or designated as unreasonable by the United States Military. Employees are required to provide a copy of their military orders and a certificate of attendance for military leave to their immediate supervisor and must also submit a copy to Human Resources as a documentation of events.

Reservists of the Armed Forces or members of the National Guard who are eligible for military leave will accrue 15 days of military leave each fiscal year for active duty, training, and inactive duty training. To be eligible for military leave, employees must be on a full-time or part-time appointment. Any portion of the 15 days that is unused in a fiscal year may be carried over to the next fiscal year, not to exceed 15 days.

Employees will continue to receive full pay while on Military Leave. Employee must immediately inform their supervisor upon notification for required National Guard Service.

Continuation of health insurance benefits is available as required by USERRA based on the length of the leave and subject to the terms, conditions, and limitations to the applicable plans for which the employee is otherwise eligible. Benefit accruals, such as vacation, or holiday benefits, will be suspended during the leave and will resume upon return to active employment.

Employees on military leave for up to thirty (30) days are required to return to work for the first regularly scheduled shift after the end of service, allowing reasonable travel time. Employees on longer military leave must apply for reinstatement in accordance with USERRA and all applicable state laws.

Employees returning from military leave will be placed in the position they would have attained had they remained continuously employed or a comparable one depending on the length of military service in accordance with USERRA. They will be treated as though they were continuously employed for purposes of determining benefits based on length of service.

5.9. Personal Judicial Proceedings

Employees may occasionally need to be absent from work to attend judicial proceedings. A request for time away from work requires immediate documentation to be provided to the Supervisor and a copy of the judicial proceedings schedule submitted to Human Resources as documentation of events. Any available earned vacation time or floating holiday will be applied to the time off; otherwise, the time will be unpaid. The Company does not discriminate against an employee using leave for this purpose. For further information, contact Human Resources.

5.10. Paid Time Off (PTO / Vacation Time)

The Company provides Paid Leave to eligible employees to support work-life balance and to comply with applicable federal, state, and local laws. Paid Leave may be used for vacation, personal time, illness, medical care, family care, and other reasons permitted by law.

This policy applies to employees nationwide. Where state or local law provides greater rights or benefits, the Company will administer Paid Leave in accordance with those laws.

5.10.1 Eligibility

- Regular full-time employees are eligible to receive Paid Leave under this policy.
- Regular part-time employees are eligible for a prorated amount of Paid Leave based on their regularly scheduled hours.
- Temporary employees, independent contractors, and interns are not eligible unless otherwise required by law.

5.10.2 Annual Paid Leave Grant

- Eligible full-time employees receive eighty (80) hours of Paid Leave per benefit year (equivalent to ten (10) workdays).
- Paid Leave is front-loaded at the beginning of each benefit year.
- Employees hired after the start of the benefit year will receive a prorated amount of Paid Leave based on their date of hire and the number of full months remaining in the benefit year.
- At the start of each new benefit year, eligible employees will receive the full annual Paid Leave grant, subject to the maximum balance cap described below.

5.10.3 Use of Paid Leave

- Employees may begin using Paid Leave after completing ninety (90) calendar days of employment, unless earlier use is required by applicable law.
- Paid Leave may be used for any lawful purpose, including but not limited to:
- Vacation or personal time
- The employee's illness, injury, or medical appointments
- Preventive care
- Care of a family member
- Reasons related to domestic violence, sexual assault, or stalking
- Any other reason permitted by applicable law
- Paid Leave must be requested in advance when foreseeable and in accordance with Company scheduling procedures. In the case of unforeseeable absences, employees must notify their supervisor as soon as practicable.
- Paid Leave may be taken in increments consistent with Company payroll practices and applicable law.

5.10.4 Rollover and Maximum Accrual

- Unused Paid Leave will roll over from one benefit year to the next.
- However, an employee's total Paid Leave balance may not exceed one hundred sixty (160) hours (equivalent to twenty (20) workdays).
- Once an employee reaches the maximum balance of 160 hours, no additional Paid Leave will be granted until the employee's balance falls below the cap.

5.10.5 Separation from Employment

- In states where Paid Leave is treated as earned wages (such as California), unused accrued Paid Leave will be paid out upon separation from employment as required by law.
- In states where payout of unused leave is not legally required, unused Paid Leave will not be paid out upon termination of employment.
- If an employee is rehired within a period required by applicable law, previously accrued leave will be reinstated as required by law.

5.10.6 Interaction With Other Leave Policies

- This Paid Leave policy is intended to satisfy applicable statutory paid leave requirements. Any additional vacation, PTO, or sick leave benefits offered by the Company are governed by separate policies and may be subject to different rules regarding accrual, rollover, and payout.

5.10.7 Administration and Policy Changes

- The Company reserves the right to interpret, administer, modify, or discontinue this policy at any time, consistent with applicable law. Nothing in this policy creates a contract of employment or guarantees employment for any specific duration.

5.11. **Sick Leaves**

The Company understands that at times, employees will need to be absent from work due to illness or other medical reasons. Because of this, we offer sick time to all full-time employees after the initial 90-day probationary period is met.

Each employee is entitled to five (5) sick days per calendar year. New hires starting after the beginning of the year will be entitled to five (5 days) prorated sick leave. Any unused sick time at the end of the year is forfeited. Unused sick leave will not be paid out and cannot be carried over to next year.

Sick time is time away from work that you elect to use if you or one of your family members is sick, for physician and dental appointments for yourself or a family member, or for any personal reasons.

If you are unable to report for work because of illness or for any other reason, please contact your supervisor immediately. If your supervisor is unavailable when you call, contact Human Resources.

5.11.1 Abuse of Sick Leave

Regular attendance is crucial to the success of the business. Paid sick leave is provided as a benefit to employees who are too injured or ill to work, not as additional time off for employees who are well. Employees should be prepared to furnish a doctor's note or similar evidence of inability to work after 3 consecutive days of missed work.

5.11.2 Extended Leave

Employees who have used up their available paid sick leave and remain unable to report on for work may be eligible for other leaves of absence, including unpaid family and medical leave (FMLA leave). Eligibility for health care benefits continues during FMLA leave.

5.12. **Pregnancy and Parental Leave Policy**

The Company recognizes that employees may need to be absent from work to care for a newborn child or newly adopted or foster child or due to a pregnancy-related condition. The Company provides pregnancy and parental leaves of absence to all eligible employees in accordance with the Family and Medical Leave Act (FMLA), Pregnancy Discrimination Act (PDA), Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) and any applicable state law.

If you need to take parental leave for the birth of your child or to care for a newly adopted or foster child, you should provide advance notice to your supervisor or the Human Resources Department. Whenever possible, you should give at least 30 days' notice of your request for leave. If 30 days' notice is not possible because of medical necessity or for other

reasons, you should give as much advance notice to the Company as possible. Written notice is preferred but not required.

If you are suffering from a pregnancy-related disability and require reasonable accommodation (which may include leave), please contact Human Resources to discuss reasonable accommodation. You may be required to submit medical certification of your disability.

Additionally, all employees are eligible for unpaid pregnancy disability leave in accordance with the PDA and ADA. Please inquire with Human Resources for information about eligibility requirements under these laws. This leave may run concurrently with other leaves where permitted by state and federal law.

For further details on 'Additional Protection for Pregnant Employees', please refer to next section of this Handbook.

5.13. **Unpaid Furlough Policy**

An unpaid furlough is a temporary, unpaid leave of absence during which employment with the Company continues, but employees do not perform work or receive wages. Furloughs may be implemented due to temporary lack of work, including client network freezes, operational slowdowns, maintenance periods, or other business conditions affecting staffing needs.

5.13.1 Eligibility and Notification:

The Company will provide written notification of furlough to affected employees as soon as practicable. The notice will include the start date, anticipated duration, reason for furlough, benefit status, and return-to-work instructions. If furlough duration changes, updated notice will be provided by Human Resources.

5.13.2 Compensation and Benefits:

During a furlough period, employees do not receive wages or salary. Health insurance coverage may continue, provided employees pay their required premium contributions. PTO does not accrue during furlough; however, employees may request use of accrued PTO, subject to approval.

5.13.3 Employee Responsibilities:

Employees on furlough must not perform any work, including responding to emails, calls, or client requests. Employees must maintain updated contact information and comply with Company instructions regarding equipment or communication during furlough.

Return to Work: Employees will be notified when work becomes available and are expected to return on the assigned date. Failure to return without approval may be

treated as voluntary resignation. Employees will generally be re-instated to their previous position, subject to business needs and any Company-wide changes.

Administration: This policy is administered by Human Resources. The Company reserves the right to modify, interpret, or discontinue this policy at its discretion and in accordance with applicable laws

SECTION 6 - Additional Protection for Pregnant Employees

The Company is dedicated to supporting employees during pregnancy, recovery from childbirth, and while managing pregnancy-related medical conditions. Federal law provides important protection to ensure you can continue working safely and comfortably.

6.1. Rights Under the PUMP Act

Under the “Providing Urgent Maternal Protections for Nursing Mothers” (PUMP Act), employers must provide:

- Reasonable break time to express breast milk for your nursing child, whenever needed.
- A private lactation space, other than a bathroom, that is shielded from view and free from intrusion.
- This accommodation must be available for one year after the child’s birth and provided each time they are needed.

6.2. Rights Under the PWFA

The Pregnant Workers Fairness Act (PWFA) requires covered employers (private and public employers with at least 15 employees, Congress, federal agencies, employment agencies, and labor organizations) to provide reasonable accommodations for known limitations related to pregnancy, childbirth, or related medical conditions.

Employers may not:

- Impose accommodation without discussion.
- Deny employment opportunities because of accommodation needs.
- Require leave if another reasonable accommodation would allow continued work.

- Retaliate against employees for reporting discrimination or participating in a PWFA proceeding.
- Interfere with employees' rights under the PWFA.

It is unlawful for an employer to terminate employment, refuse to hire, or deny reasonable accommodations because of pregnancy, childbirth, or related medical conditions.

SECTION 7 - Employee Conduct and Disciplinary Actions

7.1. Employee Conduct and Work Rules

To ensure orderly operations and provide the best possible work environment, the Company expects employees to follow rules of conduct that will protect the interests and safety of all employees and the Company. It is not possible to list all the forms of behavior that are considered unacceptable in the workplace. The following are examples of infractions of rules of conduct that may result in disciplinary action, up to and including termination of employment:

- Theft, inappropriate removal or unapproved possession of property.
- Inappropriate discounting, excessive giveaways, gifting of the Company property, inventory, or monetary items.
- Disrespecting or not following credible the Company management direction.
- Falsification of timekeeping records.
- Working impaired under the influence of alcohol, illegal drugs, prescription or OTC (over the counter) drugs.
- Possession, distribution, sale, transfer, or use of prescription drugs not previously submitted to Human Resources.
- Possession, distribution, sale, transfer, or use of alcohol or illegal drugs in any the Company workplace.
- Possession, distribution, sale, transfer, or use of alcohol or illegal drugs while operating the Company vehicles and/or equipment.

- Fighting or threatening violence or retribution in the workplace or on the immediate grounds.
- Boisterous or disruptive activity in the workplace or on the immediate grounds.
- Negligence or improper conduct leading to damage of employer-owned or customer-owned property.
- Insubordination or other disrespectful conduct. (Including religious or ethnic beliefs)
- Violation of any municipal, city, state, or federal laws (including road and transportation)
- Violation of safety or health rules including transfer of communicable diseases.
- Destruction of Company property reckless or otherwise (i.e.: equipment, vehicles, computers, fixtures, etc.).
- Smoking in areas prohibited by the Company or local and state laws. (Including smokeless tobacco devices)
- Sexual or other unlawful or unwelcome harassment and any perversion deemed unwarranted.
- Possession of dangerous or unauthorized items such as cutlery, explosives or firearms in the workplace.
- Attempting to commandeer payment for insurance related matters under false pretenses.
- Excessive absenteeism or any absence without notice.
- Unauthorized absence from workstation during the workday.
- Unauthorized use of mail systems, communication devices or any other employer-owned equipment.
- Unauthorized disclosure of business “secrets” or confidential information.

- Unsatisfactory performance or conduct related to not attaining minimum performance requirements.
- Engaging in an act of sabotage; willfully or with gross negligence, causing the destruction or damage of Company property, property of other employees, property of customers, or diminishing the reputation of the Company.
- Malicious gossiping or spreading malicious rumors.
- Engaging in behavior designed to create serious discord and lack of harmony.
- Interfering with another employee's ability to perform on the job.
- Willfully restricting work output or encouraging others to do the same.
- Harassing, disrespecting or using foul language towards any individual, regardless of if they are a customer or an employee of the Company.

7.2. Diversity and Inclusion

The Company is dedicated to creating and maintaining an atmosphere of diversity and inclusion for all.

Company values are important and are only made better by gathering the experiences, knowledge, and perspectives of people from all walks of life. We celebrate differences in age, race, ethnicity, national origin, religion, physical and mental ability, sexual orientation, gender identity or expression, family and marital status, and all the various backgrounds that help shape us all.

The Company's commitment to diversity applies to hiring practices, promotions, pay and benefits, terminations, training, team building, and more. Prospective employees and current employees alike are expected to treat each other and be treated with respect and dignity. We seek to foster an environment that promotes:

- a) A healthy, collaborative, and courteous atmosphere.
- b) Engagement from all employees that allows for more varied insights.
- c) Adjustability, where appropriate, allows for an individual's personal needs.

- d) Initiatives from the Company and the employees encourage growth in the community.

The Company is committed to providing a work environment free of sexual or any form of unlawful harassment or discrimination. Harassment or unlawful discrimination against individuals based on race, religion, creed, color, national origin, sex, pregnancy, sexual orientation, gender identity or expression, age, ancestry, physical or mental disability, genetic information, marital status, or any other classification protected by local, state, or federal laws is illegal and prohibited by Company policy. Such conduct by or towards any employee, contract worker, customer, vendor, or anyone else who does business with the Company will not be tolerated.

Any employee or contract worker who violates this policy will be subject to disciplinary action, up to and including termination of their employment or engagement. To the extent a customer, vendor or other person with whom the Company does business engages in unlawful harassment or discrimination, the Company will take appropriate corrective action.

Prohibited Conduct:

Prohibited harassment or discrimination includes any verbal, physical, or visual conduct based on sex, race, age, national origin, disability, or any other legally protected basis if:

- a) submission to such conduct is made either explicitly or implicitly a term or condition of an individual's employment or engagement.
- b) submission to or rejection of such conduct by an individual is used as a basis for decisions concerning that individual's employment or engagement; or
- c) it creates a hostile or offensive work environment.

Prohibited harassment includes (but is not limited to) unwelcome sexual advances, requests for sexual favors and lewd, vulgar, or obscene remarks, jokes, posters, or cartoons, and any unwelcome touching, pinching, or other physical contact. Other forms of unlawful harassment or discrimination may include racial epithets, slurs and derogatory remarks, stereotypes, jokes, posters, cartoons based on race, national origin, age, disability, marital status, religion, sexual orientation, veteran status, pregnancy or other legally protected categories. Prohibited harassment may also occur through the Company's electronic communication systems, including email, messaging platforms, and other digital tools, as well as through any online or social media activity that impacts the workplace.

Complaint Procedure:

Employees and contract workers who believe they have been harassed or discriminated against, or who witness such conduct by any employee, contract worker, customer, vendor, or other business partner, are strongly encouraged to report the incident immediately.

- Reporting Channels

Primary Contact: Report concern/s to your supervisor or any member of management.

Human Resources: Reports may also be directed to the Human Resources department at hr@americloudtelecom.com.

Anonymous Option: Complaints may be submitted anonymously if the employee fears retaliation.

- Handling of Complaints

Supervisor Responsibility: Any supervisor receiving a complaint must forward it immediately to Human Resources.

Confidentiality: Human Resources will treat all complaints with the highest level of confidentiality.

Supervisor Involvement: If the complaint involves the employee's supervisor, the matter should be reported directly to Human Resources, with the option of anonymous submission.

Reports related to incident or injury: An incident report must be filled out and signed by any employees who witness an incident or injury immediately following the occurrence. Failure to do so may result in disciplinary action. This policy is important for the safety and well-being of all our employees. Please refer to the Accident/Injury reporting procedure for details.

Employees are urged not to allow an inappropriate situation to continue by not reporting it, regardless of who is creating the situation. No employee, contract worker, customer, vendor, or other person who does business with this organization is exempt from the prohibitions in this policy. In response to every complaint, the Company will investigate which may involve interviewing witnesses if warranted and, if improper conduct is found, take appropriate corrective action.

To the extent that an employee or contract worker is not satisfied with the Company's handling of a harassment or discrimination complaint, they may also contact the appropriate state or federal enforcement agency for legal relief.

7.3. Individual Grievances

Individual grievances refer to complaints or concerns raised by employees regarding workplace issues that affect them personally. These may include disputes over working conditions, unfair treatment, harassment, discrimination, denial of benefits, or conflicts with supervisors or colleagues. Addressing grievances is essential to maintaining trust, morale, and a healthy organizational culture.

The Company's grievance procedure involves the following steps:

1. Reporting – Employees submit their complaint formally to HR or management.

2. Investigation – The Company reviews facts, interviews relevant parties, and gathers evidence.
3. Resolution – Management proposes corrective measures or mediation to resolve the issue.
4. Appeal – Employees may escalate the matter if they feel the resolution is unsatisfactory.

All grievances are handled by the Company in a fair, confidential, impartial, and timely manner to ensure employees feel heard and valued.

7.4. **Whistleblowing**

Whistleblowing in the workplace refers to the act of an employee reporting unethical, illegal, or harmful practices within the Company. It plays a crucial role in maintaining integrity and accountability, as it helps uncover misconduct such as fraud, discrimination, safety violations, or misuse of Company resources.

This policy is designed to encourage and enable employees to raise concerns about unethical, illegal, or unsafe practices within the organization. It ensures that whistleblowers are protected from retaliation and that reported issues are investigated promptly and fairly.

This policy applies to all employees, contractors, and stakeholders who work with or on behalf of the Company. It covers concerns related to:

- Fraud, corruption, or financial misconduct
- Health and safety violations
- Discrimination, harassment, or bullying
- Breach of company policies or legal obligations
- Any other unethical or unlawful behavior

7.4.1 Reporting Procedure

Concerns should be reported to the immediate supervisor or Human Resources. Reports may be made in writing, verbally, or through an anonymous reporting channel. All reports will be fully treated confidentially.

7.4.2 Protection Against Retaliation

Employees who raise concerns in good faith will not face dismissal, demotion, harassment, or any form of retaliation.

Retaliation against whistleblowers will result in disciplinary action, up to and including termination.

7.4.3 Investigation

All reports will be reviewed promptly and investigated impartially. Findings will be documented, and corrective actions will be taken where necessary. Whistleblowers may be informed of the outcome, subject to confidentiality requirements.

Deliberately false or malicious reports are prohibited and may result in disciplinary action against such employee.

7.5. Respect in the Workplace

Respect in the workplace goes beyond polite words; it is about creating an environment where everyone feels valued, safe, and empowered to contribute. It begins with active listening, giving colleagues your full attention during meetings or conversations, and acknowledging their ideas even if you disagree. Respect Simple gestures like saying "thank you" for someone's effort, respecting deadlines, or not interrupting during discussions, build trust and strengthen collaboration.

Respect is also about professional boundaries, recognizing personal space, honoring confidentiality, and being mindful of tone in emails or chats. Employees are encouraged to demonstrate respectfulness by giving constructive feedback rather than criticism.

7.6. Protection of Company Property

All employees should treat Company's property, whether material or intangible, with respect and care. Employees should protect Company facilities and other material property (e.g. company cars, mobile devices, laptops, etc.) from damage and vandalism, whenever possible. Any and all trash should be cleaned out of the vehicles at the end of every day. Any issues with vehicles must be reported to your supervisor immediately.

7.7. Confidentiality

In the course of employment with the Company, employees may have access to "Confidential Information" regarding the Company, which may include its business strategy, future plans, financial information, contracts, suppliers, customers, personnel information, or other information that the Company considers proprietary and confidential. Maintaining the confidentiality of this information is vital to the Company's competitive position in the industry and, ultimately, to its ability to achieve financial success and stability.

Employees must protect this information by safeguarding it when in use, using it only for the business of the Company, and disclosing it only when authorized to do so and to those who have a legitimate business need to know about it. This duty of confidentiality applies whether the employee is on or off the Company's premises, and during and even after the end of the employee's employment with the Company.

This duty of confidentiality also applies to communications transmitted by the Company's electronic communications. See also Internet, Email, and Computer Use policy, herein.

As a condition of employment with the Company, all employees must sign a Non-Disclosure Agreement.

7.8. **Drug and Alcohol Use**

AmeriCloud Telecom desire to provide a drug-free, healthful, and safe workplace that is free from alcohol and unlawful drugs as classified under local, state or federal laws including marijuana (either for medical or recreational purposes).

To promote this, employees are required to report to work in appropriate mental and physical condition to perform their jobs in a satisfactory manner. While on the premises of any the Company location and while conducting business-related activities off the Company premises, no employee may use, possess, distribute, sell, or be under the influence of alcohol, illegal drugs, controlled substances or inhalants.

The policy does not discriminate against lawful possession or proper use of prescription drugs taken by an employee as directed by the employee's physician or the possession and use of over-the-counter medications taken according to the labels directions.

However, the legal use of prescribed drugs is permitted on the job only if it does not impair an employee's ability to perform the essential functions of the job effectively and in a safe manner that does not endanger other individuals in the workplace.

Violations of this policy may lead to disciplinary action, up to and including immediate termination of employment, and/or required participation in a substance abuse rehabilitation or treatment program. Such violations may also have legal consequences.

Under the Drug-Free Workplace Act, an employee who performs work for a government contract or grant must notify the Company of a criminal conviction for drug-related activity occurring in the workplace. The report must be made within five days of the conviction.

Employees needing assistance in dealing with substance abuse problems are encouraged to seek medical treatment and rehabilitation before a violation of this policy occurs. The Company's medical benefits program may provide coverage for substance abuse treatment for eligible, enrolled employees. Employees should consult the applicable medical benefit plan documents for specific coverage details or contact Human Resources for general information.

Subject to applicable state and local law, the Company reserves the right to perform random drug screen tests, drug screen tests based on a supervisor's reasonable suspicion of an employee being under the influence of drugs and/or alcohol, and drug screen tests following an employee being involved in any work-related accident or incident involving violation of any safety or security procedures.

Employees are required to submit a list of all prescription drugs that will be consumed on premises with the Human Resources department personally as a precautionary measure in case medical attention is required.

Employees with questions on this policy or issues related to drug or alcohol use in the workplace should raise their concern with their manager or the Human Resources department without fear of reprisal.

7.9. **Smoking Policy**

In order to deliver quality experience to all of our customers, the Company requires all employees to observe local, state, federal and municipal laws concerning smoking in prohibited areas. The Company respects the freedom of those employees who do smoke or use smokeless tobacco products, however, compliance to the most current laws are mandatory. As a standard of compliance employees must maintain a distance of no less than 50 feet away from any the Company "employee only" entrance and at least 75 feet away from a customer entrance. Furthermore, smoking is strictly prohibited inside the company facility, office, customer premises, etc.

Cigarette or cigar butts, smokeless tobacco products, spittle, packages, wrapping, matches, ashtrays, or lighters must not be left in plain view or strewn in the customers area of vision within the parking lot. Duration and frequency of cigarette breaks must be kept to a minimum as all breaks require the employee to follow proper timekeeping procedures and require the manager to log timekeeping records correctly. Employees who smoke are required to practice due diligence that ensures no traces of first, or second-hand smoke, related odors, smoking / smokeless tobacco residue, or any noticeable carcinogenic presence when engaging fellow employees, vendors, or the general public while in the vicinity of the Company location whether on or off duty.

Infractions to this policy concerning smoking, as well as timekeeping, may lead to further disciplinary action.

7.10. **Medical Emergencies**

In most emergencies, common sense usually dictates the course of action to be taken (especially those involving personal injury). In any emergency, if you are a witness, it is your duty to remain on the accident site until it is resolved or until competent personnel relieve you. An employee who is injured on the job must report the injury immediately including a full written description of the incident. Failure to report an injury, whether or not medical attention is needed, may result in the loss of any accident insurance through the Workers Compensation coverage and benefits. Do not admit guilt, make verbal claims of support and/or restitution, or sign anything related to the emergency. During Medical Emergency, the following should be observed:

- Immediately notify your supervisor.
- Report all injuries even if medical attention is not needed.
- Call 911 (for life threatening emergencies or when applicable)

- Wait for help to arrive, do not administer first aid unless certified. Only trained staff can provide first aid/CPR.
- Prepare a written statement with a complete description of the incident for Human Resources.

7.11. Anti-Discrimination Policy

The Company is committed to providing a work environment that is free from all forms of discrimination and conduct that can be considered discriminatory.

Specifically, the Company may not terminate, refuse to hire, or otherwise discriminate against a person, in any matter directly or indirectly related to employment because of race, color, religion, creed, national origin, ancestry, sex (including pregnancy), gender (including gender nonconformity and status as a transgender or transsexual individual), sexual orientation, age, physical or mental disability, past, current or prospective service in the uniformed services, or any other characteristic protected under applicable federal, state or local law.

7.12. Anti-Harassment Policy

The Company strictly prohibits and does not tolerate unlawful harassment against employees or any other covered persons because of race, color, religion, creed, national origin, ancestry, sex (including pregnancy), gender (including gender nonconformity and status as a transgender or transsexual individual), sexual orientation, age, physical or mental disability, citizenship, past, current or prospective service in the uniformed services, or any other characteristic protected under applicable federal, state or local law.

7.13. Anti-Retaliation Policy

The Company strictly prohibits and does not tolerate unlawful retaliation against any employee, by any employee. All forms of unlawful retaliation are prohibited, including any form of discipline, reprisal, intimidation or other form of retaliation for participating in any activity protected by law.

7.14. Romance in the Workplace Policy

In order to minimize the risk of conflicts of interest and promote fairness, the Company maintains the following policy with respect to romance in the workplace:

No person in a management or supervisory position shall have a romantic or dating relationship with an employee whom he or she directly supervises or whose terms or conditions of employment he or she may influence (examples of terms or conditions of employment include promotion, termination, discipline and compensation). In addition, no

employees working in the same department shall have such a relationship. A department is defined as a group of employees who report directly to the same supervisor.

To the extent it is possible, a supervisor or manager who has had a previous romantic or dating relationship with a subordinate or employee whose terms and conditions he or she may influence will not be involved in decisions relating to that individual's promotions, raises, termination or other terms and conditions of employment.

All employees engaged in a romantic or dating relationship are required to notify Human Resources.

Employees are expected to always conduct themselves in a professional manner. Workplace dating or romantic relationships must not interfere with any employee's professionalism, including treating others with respect and refraining from behavior that may make others feel uncomfortable (for example, overt physical displays of affection and using sexual language). Management personnel are expected to set a high standard of professional conduct both at work and in any social setting at events sponsored by the Company. For this reason, management personnel are prohibited from social interaction with subordinates that is or might be perceived as inappropriate (for example, unwanted flirting, touching or other behavior that may be regarded as sexual harassment).

The Company retains discretion in its enforcement of this policy. Decisions made under this policy will be made based on operational and business reasons and without regard to sex, race, color, religion, creed, age, national origin, citizenship, physical or mental disability, military service or application, other applicable protected classes for relevant state(s) or any other protected characteristic under federal, state or local law.

7.15. Workplace Violence Policy

The Company prohibits and will not tolerate any form of workplace violence by an employee, supervisor or third party, including vendors, customers, and visitors both at the workplace and at employer-sponsored events.

For purposes of this policy, workplace violence includes:

- Making threatening remarks (written or verbal).
- Aggressive or hostile acts such as shouting, using profanity, throwing objects at another person, fighting or intentionally damaging a co-worker's property.
- Bullying, intimidating or harassing another person (for example, making obscene phone calls or using threatening body language or gestures such as standing close to someone or shaking your fist at them).
- Behavior that causes another person emotional distress or creates a reasonable fear of injury, such as stalking.

- Assault.

This list is illustrative only and not exhaustive. No form of workplace violence will be tolerated.

The Company prohibits all employees from possessing any weapons of any kind both at the workplace, while engaged in activities for the Company, and at the client's premises. For purposes of this policy, the workplace is defined to include Company buildings, outdoor areas and parking lots. Weapons include:

- Guns
- Knives
- Mace
- Explosives
- Any item with the potential to inflict harm that has no common purpose.

This list is illustrative only, and not exhaustive. The Company prohibits employees from possessing any weapon at the workplace.

If you witness or are subjected to any conduct you believe violates this policy, you must speak, write or otherwise contact your direct supervisor/manager or, if the conduct involves your direct supervisor and Human Resources as soon as possible.

Your complaint should be as detailed as possible, including the names of all individuals involved and any witnesses.

The Company will directly and thoroughly investigate all reports of workplace violence and will take prompt corrective action, including disciplinary measures, if appropriate. The Company reserves the right to contact law enforcement, if appropriate. To the extent permitted by law, the Company reserves the right to seek a restraining order or other legal remedies to prevent workplace violence against an employee.

If you become aware of an imminent violent act or threat of an imminent violent act, immediately contact appropriate law enforcement then contact your supervisor and Human Resources department.

The Company prohibits any form of discipline, reprisal, intimidation or retaliation for reporting incidents of workplace violence of any kind, pursuing a workplace violence complaint or cooperating in related investigations.

The Company is committed to enforcing this policy against all forms of workplace violence. However, the effectiveness of our efforts depends largely on employees telling us about all incidents of workplace violence, including threats. Employees who witness any workplace

violence should report it immediately. In addition, if an employee feels that they or someone else may have been subjected to conduct that violates this policy, they should report it immediately. If employees do not report workplace violence incidents, the Company may not become aware of a possible violation of this policy and may not be able to take appropriate corrective action.

7.16. Gifts and Hospitality

The Company's policy on receiving gifts and hospitality is designed to uphold transparency, integrity, and ethical business practices. Employees must avoid accepting gifts or hospitality that could influence or appear to influence business decisions, and all such instances should be reported to Human Resources.

While nominal items of small value, such as company-branded stationery or modest tokens, and reasonable hospitality directly related to business discussions may be acceptable, cash or cash equivalents, lavish or frequent hospitality, or any unreported gifts are strictly prohibited. All gifts and hospitality must be recorded in the Gifts & Hospitality Register, and any uncertainty should be discussed with the Compliance/Human Resources Department before acceptance to ensure compliance with Company policy, local laws, and industry regulations.

7.17. Disciplinary Action

As an at-will employer, the Company may impose discipline whenever it determines whether it is necessary or appropriate. Discipline may take various forms, including verbal counseling, written warnings, suspension, demotion, transfer, reassignment, or termination. The discipline imposed will depend on the circumstances of each case; therefore, discipline will not necessarily be imposed in any sequence. Moreover, at any time the Company determines it is appropriate, an employee may be terminated immediately.

7.18. Attendance and Reporting Policy

The Company expects that every employee will be regular and punctual in attendance. This means being at the office/site, ready to work at the starting time each day. Absenteeism and tardiness place a burden on both co-workers and the Company and can negatively affect productivity and morale.

Employees are expected to follow their schedules. While exceptions can be made for occasions that prevent employees from adhering to standard working hours or days, punctuality is essential, and employees are generally expected to arrive on time and be ready to work at the beginning of the day or their shift.

Reporting Absences:

If you are unable to report to work or will be late for any reason, you must notify your supervisor, department manager, or facility manager at least two (2) hours prior to the beginning of your scheduled shift.

Notification must be provided personally unless you are physically unable to do so, in which case you may have someone else contact your supervisor. You must provide the reason for your absence and the expected date of your return. If you need to leave during your shift, you must obtain your supervisor's approval as soon as you are aware of the need to leave, but no later than one hour before your departure (except in emergencies).

Unreported Absences:

Failure to contact your supervisor or report for work for five (5) consecutive workdays will be treated as a voluntary resignation, and your position may be filled. If you can provide an acceptable explanation with appropriate substantiation, this policy may not apply.

Excessive Absenteeism:

Excessive absenteeism, even if reported, may result in disciplinary action up to and including termination.

AmeriCloud Solutions, in its sole discretion, will determine excessive absenteeism. The following are examples:

- Twelve (12) full or partial days absent, consecutive or not, within any 12-month period.
- Three (3) full or partial days absent, consecutive or not, within any 30-day period.
- Five (5) full or partial days absent, consecutive or not, within any 6-month period.

Time off for medical/dental appointments, school activities, or other personal business will not be considered excessive absenteeism if pre-approved by your supervisor at least three business days in advance, but these absences will still be documented.

Tardiness:

You are tardy if you arrive at your workstation late or are not appropriately groomed, dressed, and ready to work at the beginning of your scheduled shift. Tardiness also includes returning late from breaks or meal periods. If you are more than 30 minutes late, it will be counted as an absence.

Reporting Tardiness:

If you anticipate being late, you must notify your supervisor at least two (2) hours before your scheduled shift.

If you cannot make the call yourself, someone else may contact your supervisor on your behalf. Failure to report tardiness will count toward excessive absenteeism or excessive tardiness.

Excessive Tardiness:

Excessive tardiness, even if reported, will result in disciplinary action, up to and including termination. Examples include:

- Tardiness on three (3) or more days within any 30-day period.
- Tardiness on five (5) or more days within any 3-month period.
- Tardiness on twelve (12) or more days within any 12-month period.

Disciplinary Action:

Employees with excessive absenteeism or tardiness may face disciplinary measures up to and including termination, at the discretion of the Company.

7.19. Workplace Searches

All offices, desks, file drawers, cabinets, lockers, Company vehicles, and other Company equipment (including but not limited to computers, email and voice mail) and facilities or any area on Company premises are the property of the Company ("Company Property") and are intended for business use. Employees should have no expectation of privacy with respect to Company Property and/or items stored within Company Property or on the Company's premises. Inspection may be conducted at any time, without notice, at the discretion of the Company.

In addition, when the Company deems it appropriate, employees may be required to submit searches of their personal vehicles, parcels, purses, handbags, backpacks, briefcases, lunch boxes, or any other possessions or articles brought onto the Company's premises.

People entering the premises who refuse to cooperate in an inspection conducted pursuant to this policy may not be permitted to enter the premises. All employees must cooperate in an inspection; failure to do so is insubordination and will result in disciplinary action, up to and including termination.

7.20. Resignation

The Company is an at-will employer; therefore, resignation is a voluntary act initiated by an employee to terminate their employment. Although advance notice is not required, the Company does request at least 2 weeks' written resignation notice from all employees to Human Resources. Prior to an employee's departure, an exit interview may be scheduled to discuss the reasons for resignation. If an employee does not provide advance notice as requested, the employee may be considered ineligible for rehire.

Upon resignation or termination of employment, the employee remains bound by the company's non-compete, non-solicitation, and confidentiality obligations. The non-compete clause prohibits the employee from engaging in employment or business activities that directly compete with the company for a defined period following departure. The non-solicitation clause restricts the employee from soliciting or attempting to solicit the company's clients, customers, or employees for personal or competitive gain. The

confidentiality clause requires the employee to maintain strict secrecy regarding all proprietary, sensitive, or non-public information acquired during employment, with such obligation continuing indefinitely after separation. These provisions are mandatory to safeguard the Company's business interests, workforce stability, and intellectual property.

Final settlement of dues will include payment for accrued but unused PTO (if any). Payment will be made on the next regular payday.

7.21. Return of Property In-Use

Employees are responsible for all the Company property, materials, cash or written information issued to them or in their possession or control. Employees must return all the Company property immediately upon request or upon termination (on or before last day of employment), in condition it was given to them, including but not limited to Company documents, equipment, credit card/s, storage keys, vehicles, devices, uniforms, etc. Where permitted by applicable laws, the Company may withhold from the employee's check or final paycheck the cost of any items that are not returned when required or are returned in a degraded condition. The Company may also take actions deemed appropriate to recover or protect its property up to and including prosecution.

7.22. Exit Interviews

All employees leaving the Company's employment either voluntarily or involuntarily, with or without cause, may have an exit interview with Human Resources. This meeting will allow the employees to discuss reasons for their departure and to convey any concerns. After the exit interview a determination on next steps will be discussed with the employee either at that point or at some other time in the future.

SECTION 8 - Exhibits to this Handbook:

- Company Employee Policy Handbook Acknowledgment
- Accident/Incident Reporting form
- Company Safe Driving Policy Acknowledgment
- Handling Personal Customer Information Acknowledgment
- Family and Medical Leave Act (FMLA) Acknowledgment
- Drug Testing in the Workplace Policy Acknowledgment
- Internet Usage Policy Acknowledgment
- Company Travel Policy Acknowledgment